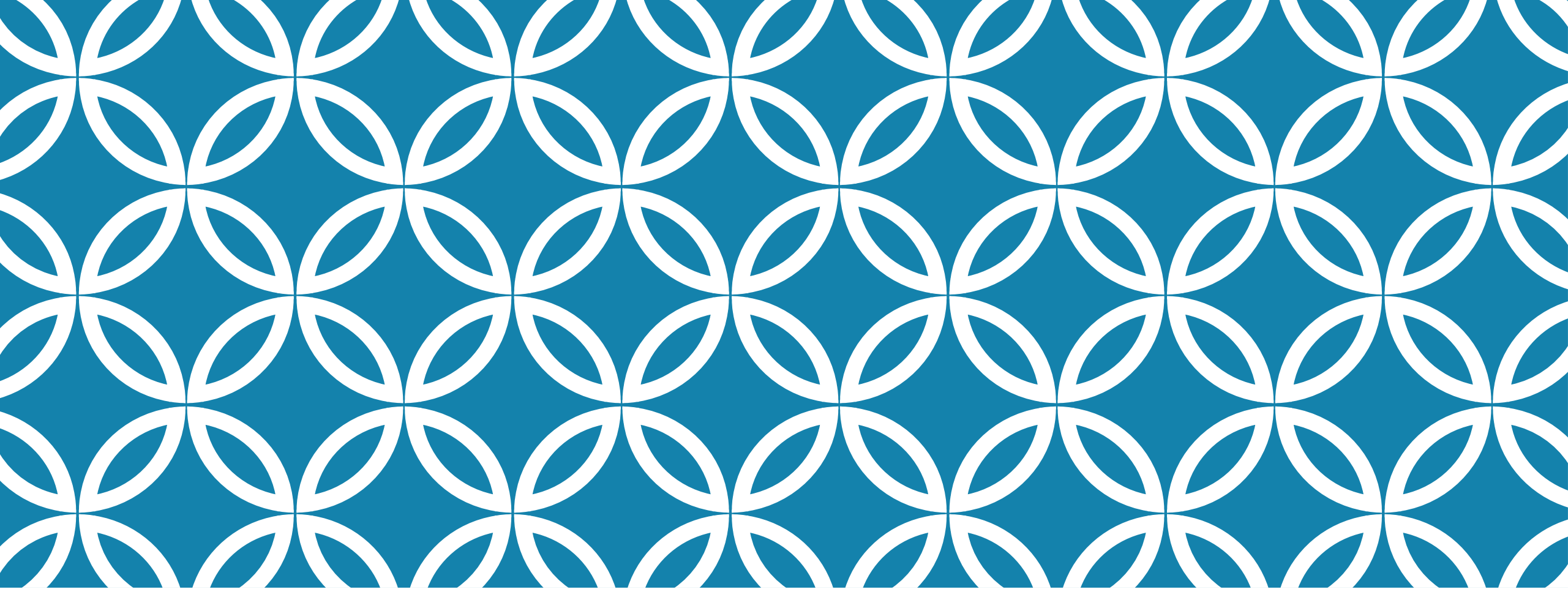




PUBP309: EDUCATION POLICY

Education in Colonial India
Nationalism to Dyarchy and Compulsory
Education

Shivakumar Jolad
FLAME University

COMPULSORY EDUCATION AND EDUCATION DECENTRALIZ ATION 1880- 1921

RIGHT TO EDUCATION

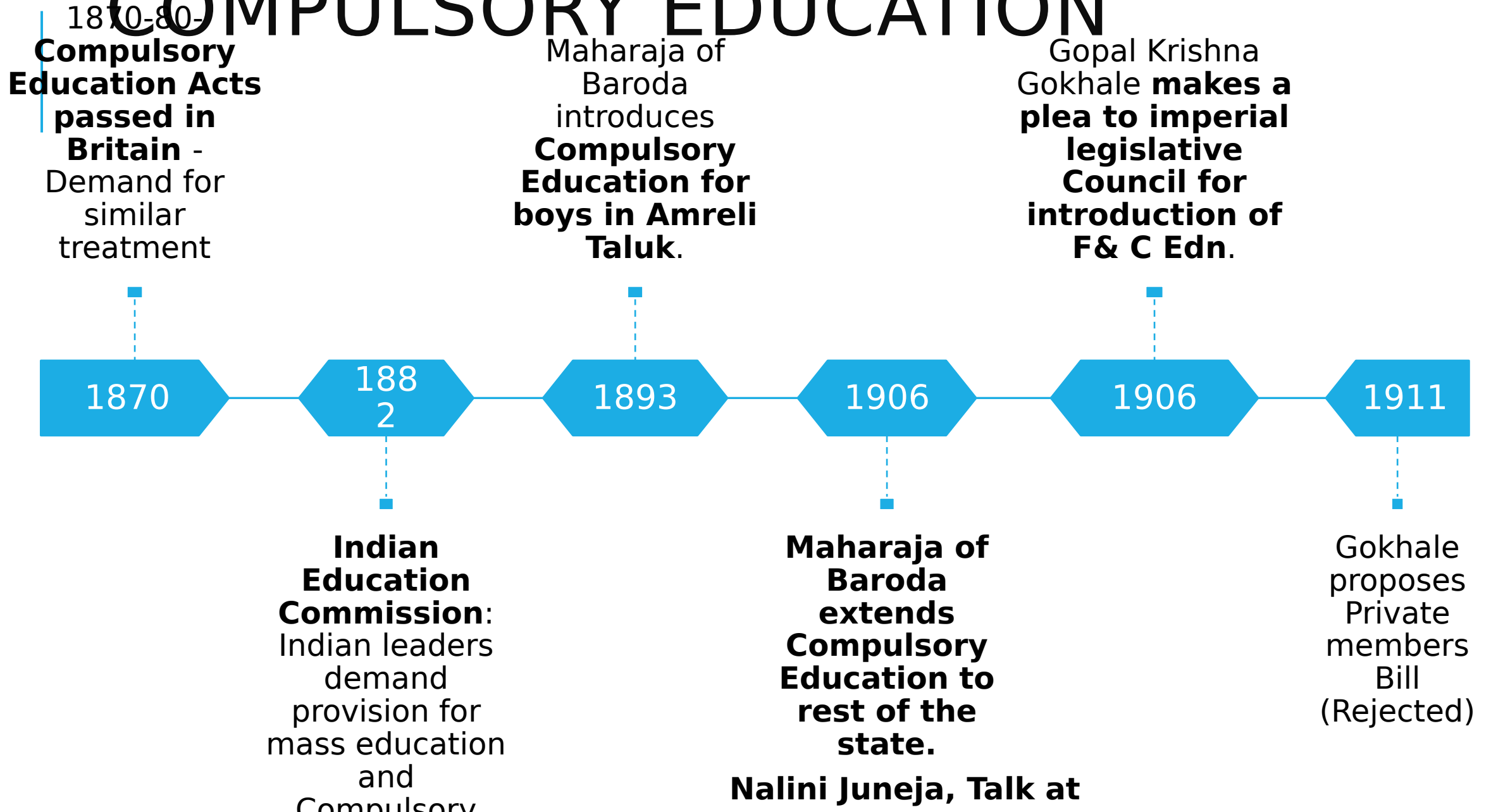
“Right to education act” (Right to Children to Free and Compulsory Education), passed in 2009 , and became a law from 1st April 2010.

“I am what I am today because of education. I want every Indian child, girl and boy, to be so touched by the light of education.... About a hundred years ago a great son of India, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, urged the Imperial Legislative Assembly to confer on the Indian people the Right to Education.”

Former Prime Minister- Manmohan Singh, 2009
<http://www.catalign.in/2010/04/Ideas-dont-die-easily-gopal-krishna.html>



ATTEMPTS FOR FREE AND COMPULSORY EDUCATION



PRIMARY EDUCATION: COMPULSORY EDU ACTS 1919-1930

Year	Province	Name of the Act	Compulsion whether for Boys or Girls	Whether applicable to Rural or Urban Areas
1919	Punjab	Primary Education Act	Boys	Both
"	United Provinces	"	Both	Municipal
"	Bengal	"	Boys (extended to girls by an amendment in 1932)	"
"	Bihar and Orissa	"	Boys	Both
1920	Bombay	City of Bombay P. E. Act	Both	Applicable to City of Bombay only
"	Central Provinces	P. E. Act	"	Both
"	Madras	Elementary Education Act	"	"
1923	Bombay	P. E. Act	"	Applicable to the whole of the Province except Bombay City
1926	Assam	"	"	Both
"	United Provinces	District Boards P. E. Act	"	To rural areas only
1930	Bengal	Bengal (Rural) P. E. Act	"	"

TABLE II Areas under Compulsion		
Province	Municipalities and Urban Areas	District Boards and Rural Areas
Madras	21	1
Bombay	6	—
United Provinces	25	—
Punjab	57	1,499
Bihar and Orissa	1	3
Central Provinces	3	66
Delhi	1	—
Total	114	1,571

N.B.—The rural areas in the Punjab are the areas served by individual schools.

PROGRESS IN COMPULSORY EDUCATION: 1937-45

Compulsory Primary Education, 1947-48

Province	Age-group under compulsion	Area with boys only under compulsion		Area with boys and girls under compulsion	
		No. of towns and cities	No. of villages	No. of towns and cities	No. of villages
Bihar	6-10	17	—	—	—
Bombay	7-8, 6-11	9	134	110	5,100
C.P. and Berar	6-11, 7-12	34	1,031	—	—
East Punjab	6-11	37	1,420	—	—
Madras	6-14, 6-12	16	31	12	1,607
Orissa	6-12, 6-13, 5-10	1	1	—	—
U.P.*	6-11	36	1,371	3	3
West Bengal	6-10	1	—	—	—
Delhi	6-12	1	7	—	—

*Figures relate to 1946-47.

If these statistics are compared with those of 1936-37, it will be noticed that **the best progress was made in Bombay where compulsion was introduced in several municipal areas and in all villages** with a population of 1,000 or more. .

In **other parts of India, the progress can only be called poor**. When it is remembered that the nation was irrevocably committed to the introduction of compulsory education for boys and girls in the age group of 6 to 14 before 1960-61, it becomes at once evident that the **progress of compulsory education in the past, if it can be called progress at all, was extremely disappointing**

COMPULSORY EDUCATION ACTS

Table I. Compulsory Education Acts in British India.

Year	Province	Name of Act	Whether for boys or girls	Areas
1919	Punjab	P.E. Act	Boys	Rural & Municipal
1919	United Provinces	P.E. Act	Both	Municipal
1919	Bengal	P.E. Act	Boys	Municipal
1919	Bihar & Orissa	P.E. Act	Boys	Rural & Municipal
1920	Bombay	City of Bombay P.E. Act	Both	City of Bombay
1920	Central Provinces	P.E. Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1920	Madras	Elementary Education Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1923	Bombay	P.E. Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1926	Assam	P.E. Act	Both	Rural & Municipal
1926	United Provinces	District Boards P.E. Act	Both	Rural
1930	Bengal	Bengal (Rural) P.E. Act	Both	Rural
1932	Bengal	P.E. (Amendment) Act	Girls	Municipal
1939	N.W.F.	P.E. Act	Boys	Rural & Municipal

Source. Naik (1942b, p. 12), Nurullah and Naik (1970, p. 302).

Note. P.E. = Primary Education; N.W.F. = North West Frontier.

Schools in Colonial India -1929

Percentage of primary educational Institutions by management and provinces- 1929

Review by Hartog Committee 1929, (includes Male and Female schools)

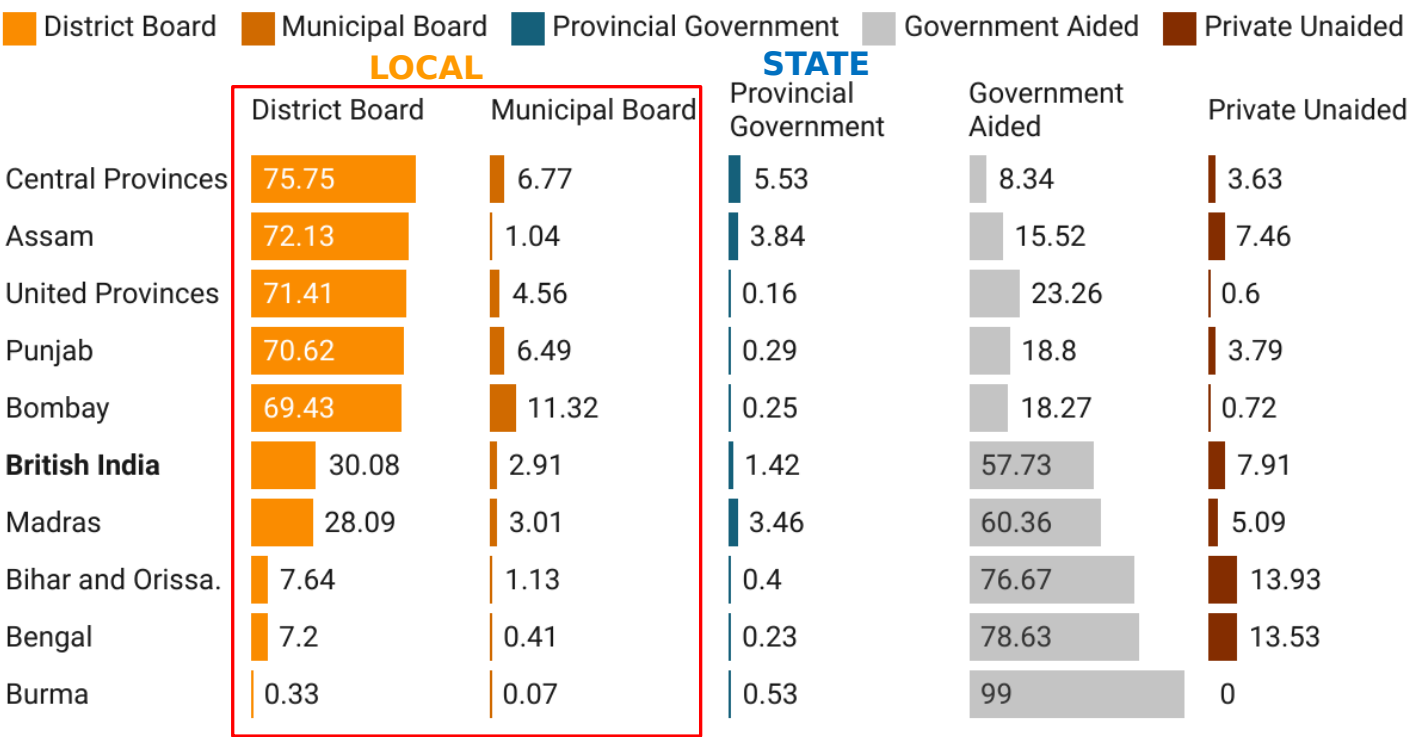


Chart: Shivakumar Jolad • Source: Auxiallry Committee (Education) of the Indian Statutory Commission 1929 • Created with Datawrapper

INTERIM REPORT

the Indian Statutory Commission.

of Growth of Education in British India by the
ry Committee appointed by the Commission.)
SEPTEMBER, 1929.

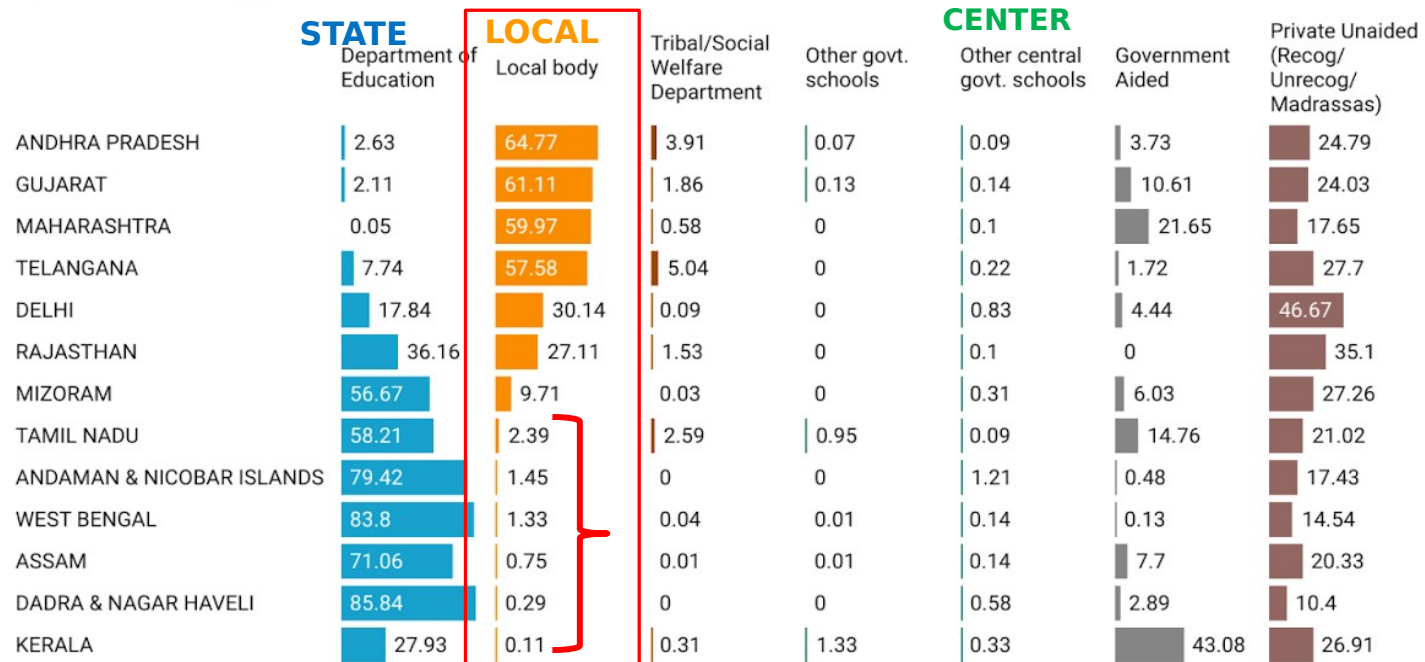


Philip Hartog

Percentage of Schools by Management in different States in India

Based on UDISE 2019-20

■ Department of Education
 ■ Local body
 ■ Tribal/Social Welfare Department
 ■ Other govt. schools
 ■ Other central govt. schools
 ■ Government Aided
 ■ Private Unaided (Recog/ Unrecog/ Madrassas)

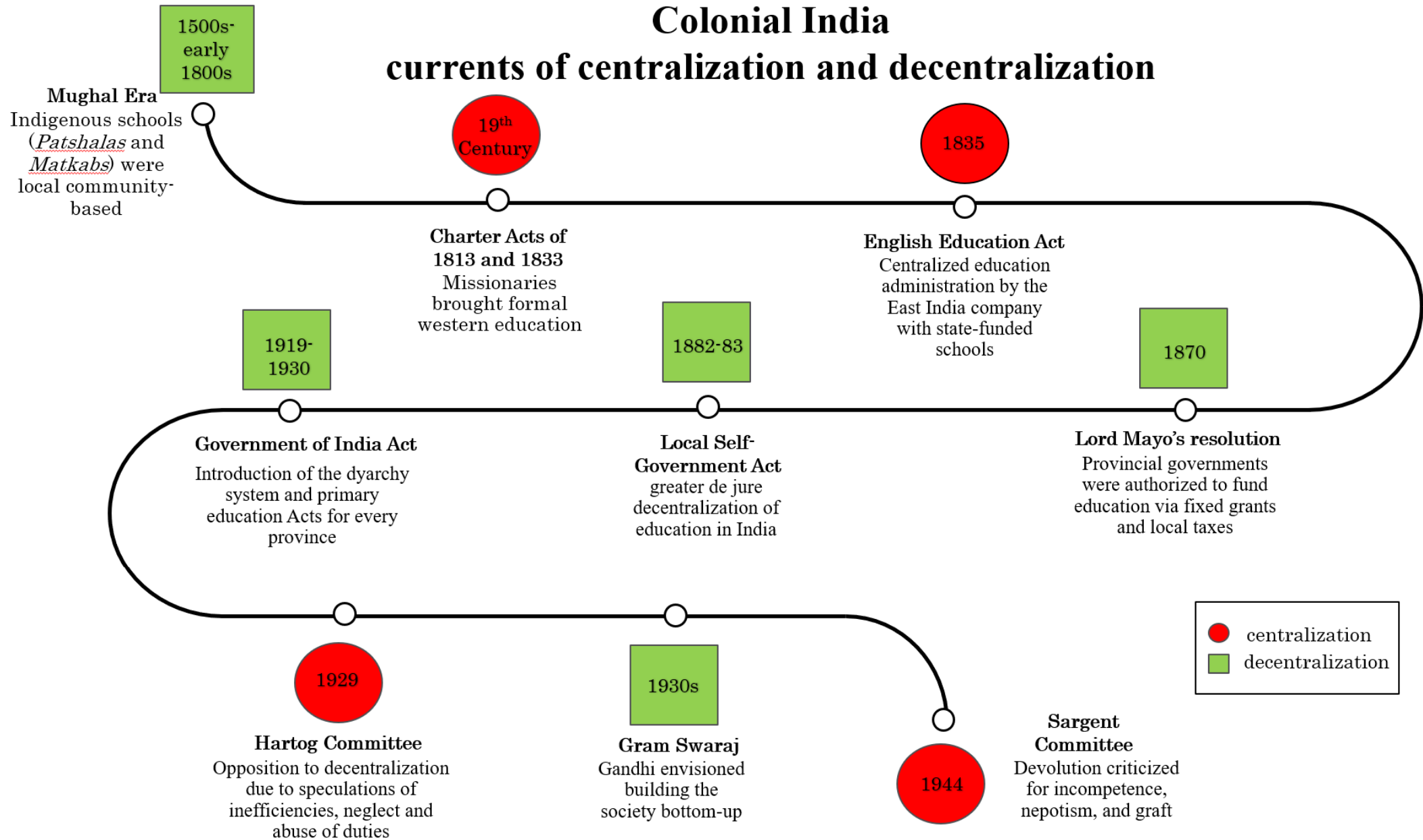


NAGALAND	72.52	0	0.11	0	0.62	0	26.75
ODISHA	78.58	0	2.43	0.17	0.15	8.34	10.34
PONDICHERRY	57.12	0	0.28	0	1.11	4.56	36.93
TRIPURA	87.12	0	0.2	0.04	0.26	0.94	11.43
INDIA	54.73	12.8	3.05	0.08	0.16	5.54	23.64

Chart: Khushi Rajpuria and Shivakumar Jolad • Source: UDISE 2019-20 • Created with Datawrapper

Colonial India

currents of centralization and decentralization





EDUCATION UNDER PROVINCIAL AUTONOMY

1936-1945

ROUND TABLE CONFERENCES

RTC-1: (November 1930 – January 1931)

- ▣ No INC participation
- ▣ Gandhi Irwin Pact

RTC-2 : (September – December 1931)

RTC-3: (November – December 1932)



Second Round Table Conference in London - 1931



PROVINCIAL AUTONOMY

August 1935: Government of India Act was passed – long tortuous process since the Simon commission in 1927

Put **an end to the diarchy system of administration** set up in 1919

Elected representatives were Indians

Removed the distinction between reserved and transferred subjects.

Provincial Autonomy came into existence in 1937 eleven provinces

Government of India Act, 1935.

[26 GEO. 5. CH. 2.]



ARRANGEMENT OF SECTIONS.

A.D. 1935.

PART I.

INTRODUCTORY.

Section.

1. Short title.
2. Government of India by the Crown.
3. The Governor-General of India and His Majesty's Representative as regards relations with Indian States.
4. The Commander-in-Chief in India.

PART II.

THE FEDERATION OF INDIA.

CHAPTER I.

ESTABLISHMENT OF FEDERATION AND ACCESSION OF INDIAN STATES.

5. Proclamation of Federation of India.
6. Accession of Indian States.

SCENARIO FOR EDUCATION UNDER PROVINCIAL AUTONOMY

Hopes for greater educational advancement

- Economic depression had ended. There were greater hopes for educational improvements
- **Indian Education Service (IES)** service has been liquidated with very few European officers remaining

Congress in power : 1937-39 and 1946-47, in between - caretaker govt

1939-45 Second world war

1942- Quit India movement

Fight between INC, Muslim League and British

EDUCATIONAL PROGRESS 1937-47

Govt of India

- Changes in educational administration by the Government of India Act, 1935;
- **educational activities of the Government of India;**
- developments in university, secondary, primary, and vocational education-

Contributions of Indian Congress

- **Basic Education**
- Adult Education (including large-scale literacy campaigns),
- intensive efforts to abolish untouchability and to spread education among the Harijans.

Educational Planning

- the All-India Educational Conference (**Wardha Conference**)- ; the National Planning Committee- Zakhir Hussain Committee
- Central Advisory Board of Education;
- **Sargent Plan** - and Five Year Plans (1947-52) preparation

EDUCATION UNDER GOVT OF INDIA ACT 1935

Edu admin in two main categories: **Federal** (Central) and **state** (Provincial)

Federal (or Central) Subjects

- ▢ The Imperial Library, Calcutta; the Indian Museum, Calcutta; the Imperial War Museum; the Victoria Memorial, Calcutta; and any similar institution controlled or financed by the Federation;
- ▢ **Education in the Defence forces; The Banaras Hindu University and the Aligarh Muslim University; Education in centrally administered areas.**

State (or provincial) Subjects

- ▢ All matters regarding education other than those which have been included in the Federal list given above were regarded as State or Provincial subjects.

EXPANSION OF PRIMARY EDUCATION AND LITERACY

From the foregoing account which reveals **only a slow progress in primary education**, it can be easily imagined that the progress **of literacy would also' be correspondingly slow.**

The **census of 1941** gave an **overall literacy percentage of 12.2%** for British India. This compares favourably with the literacy percentage of **1931 (7 per cent)** and shows that the literacy rose by 5 per cent in the decade 1931-41 whereas the corresponding **rise in the decades between 1881 and 1931 had been about 4 per cent only.**

Thus the situation may be said to have improved somewhat between 1931 and

Expansion of Primary Education (1937-47)

Year	No. of Primary Schools	No of pupils
1881-82	82,916	2,061,541
1901-02	93,604	3,076,671
1921-22	155,017	6,109,752
1936-37	192,244	10,224,288
1945-46	167,700	13,027,313
1946-47	134,866	10,525,943

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Progress of Illiteracy in India (1931-41)

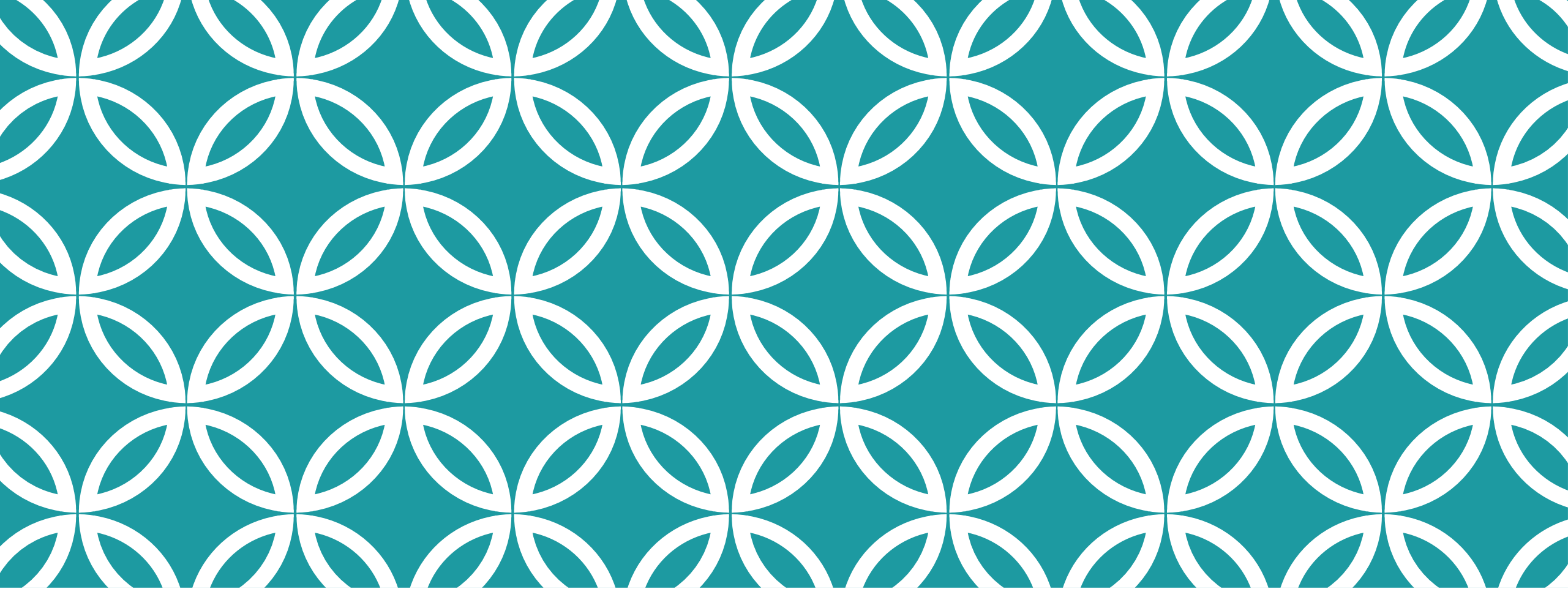
(The figures are in thousands)

Province or State	In 1931				From 1932 to 1941			
	Total Population	No. of Literates	Per-centage of Literacy	No. of Illiterates on hand	No. of Illiterates added (Increase in Population)	No. of Illiterates reduced (Increase in Literates)	Per-centage of Literacy	Net in-crease in Illiteracy
Bombay	17,992	1,774	9.5	16,218	2,866	2,294	19.5	572
Madras	46,740	4,320	9.3	42,420	2,602	2,101	13.0	501
Bengal	50,114	4,694	9.4	45,420	10,200	5,026	16.1	5,174
Bihar	32,371	1,344	4.2	31,027	3,969	1,996	9.2	1,973
Orissa	5,306	539	10.2	4,767	3,423	409	10.9	3,014
U. P.	48,409	2,260	4.8	46,149	6,312	2,393	8.5	3,919
C. P.	14,667	868	5.9	13,799	2,155	1,042	11.3	1,113
N. W. F.	2,425	100	4.1	2,325	613	134	7.7	479
Punjab	23,581	1,248	5.3	22,333	4,838	2,418	12.9	2,420
Sind	3,887	230	5.9	3,657	650	244	10.5	406
Assam	8,622	666	7.7	7,956	1,583	508	11.5	1,075
Travancore	5,096	1,218	23.9	3,878	974	1,176	47.7	202
Cochin	1,205	339	28.1	866	218	165	35.4	53
Baroda	2,443	435	17.7	2,008	412	222	23.0	190
Gwalior	3,523	141	4.4	3,382	469	156	7.4	313
Hyderabad	14,436	596	4.1	13,840	1,748	515	6.9	1,233
Kashmir	3,646	124	3.4	3,422	375	140	6.5	235
Mysore	6,557	594	9.1	5,963	772	320	12.2	470
All India	3,38,170	23,493	7.0	3,14,677	50,630	23,830	12.2	26,800

Nurullah
and
Naik

EXPANSION OF UNIVERSITY EDUCATION

Serial No.	Name of the University	Date of Foundation	Type	Number of Students	Total Expenditure (in thousands)	Government Grant (in thousands)	Percentage of Government Grant to total Income
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Calcutta	1857	Affiliating and Teaching	45,008	3,922	938	22.9
2	Bombay	1857	Do.	43,090	2,695	209	8.6
3	Madras	1857	Do. Federative	28,888	1,650	460	23.4
4	Allahabad	1887	Teaching	3,502	1,672	793	52.88
5	Banaras	1916	Teaching	5,083	12,580	1,270	9.2
6	Mysore	1916	Teaching and Affiliating	9,350	2,548	1,700	69.2
7	Patna	1917	Do.	5,471	864	61	7.2
8	Osmania	1918	Teaching	4,862	3,492	3,498	91.3
9	Aligarh	1920	Do.	4,009	1,570	560	35.7
10	Lucknow	1920	Do.	3,893	2,223	1,070	53.3
11	Delhi	1922	Do. Federative	4,311	977	593	52.4



BASIC EDUCATION |

GANDHI'S SCHEME OF BASIC EDUCATION

Gandhi strongly opposed the Western system of education.. Critiques it as trash in *Hind Swaraj* ! **“I am convinced that the present system of education is not only wasteful but positively harmful”**

Post 1935, felt “an irresistible call” (book- *Educational Reconstruction*) .. to make charge that ***present mode of education is wrong from bottom to top.***

Idea of education : **“self supporting and all round development”- to serve the needs of self and the community** (villages). Vocations such as carpentry, plumbing, processing cotton, tools.



...e used partially used to pay

<http://www.kkhsou.in/main/education/wardha.html>

WARDHA SCHEME - BACKGROUND

This basic education experiment required huge sum of money which meant fresh taxation. **Mahatma Gandhi promised to introduce total prohibition** which again meant the loss of a huge amount of revenue. Congress was committed to both '**prohibition and compulsion**'.

Gandhi's proposal: Free and compulsory primary education could be given to every child *if the **process of schooling could be made self supporting by imparting education through a useful and productive craft.***

Gandhi expressed his views on education through a series of articles in '**Harijan**' in **June 31, 1937**, which later on developed into the *Wardha Scheme of Basic Education*.

The views of Gandhii created controversies in the academic circles. Therefore it was desirable to get the scheme examined by experts and educationists. Finally, Gandhi placed his **Basic Education System to the nation in the Wardha Conference in 1937.**

WARDHA CONFERENCE (1937)- RESOLUTIONS

That in the opinion of this conference, ***free and compulsory education be provided on a nation-wide scale.***

That the **medium of instruction be the mother tongue.**

That the process of education through this period should centre round some form of manual productive work suitable for the local condition.

That the conference expects that the system of education will be gradually able to cover the remuneration of the teacher.

The conference then appointed a **committee under the Chairmanship of Dr. Zakir Hussain to prepare a detailed education plan and syllabus** on the lines of the above resolutions.



Sevagram,
Wardha

(Alamy stock
photo)

ZAKHIR HUSSAIN COMMITTEE REPORT

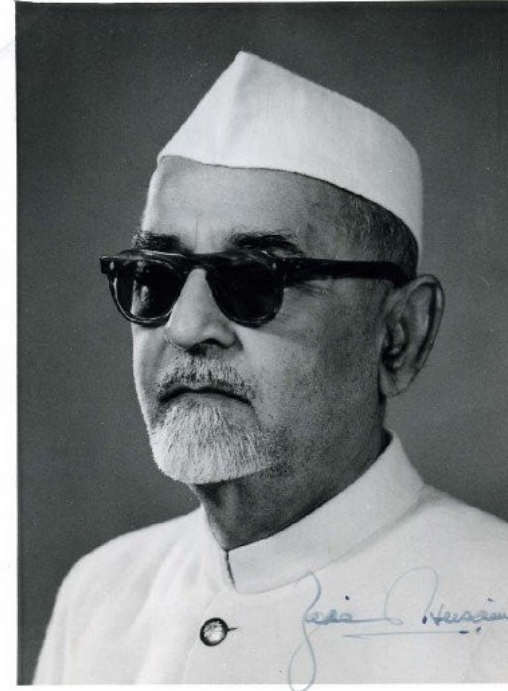
First part 1937, second one in 1938

The first report included the **basic principles of the Wardha Scheme of education**, its aims, teachers and their training, organisation of schools, administration, inspection and inclusion of craft centred education regarding handicrafts like spinning, weaving etc.

The second report dealt with **Agriculture, Metal work, Wood craft and other basic handicraft**. An elaborate curriculum of all those subjects and ways and means to establish their correlation with other subjects was also suggested.

Productive work would relieve the child from purely academic and theoretic work... and **socially it would tend to break down the existing barriers of prejudice between manual and intellectual workers**

Warned against overstressing economic importance at the sacrifice of educational and cultural objectives



ZAKHIR HUSSAIN COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS

Free, universal and compulsory education should be provided for all boys and girls between the ages of 7—14.

This education should be imparted in the **mother-tongue of the child.**

All education should centre round some basic craft chosen with due regard to the capacity of children and the needs of the locality. The committee suggested spinning and weaving, card-board and wood work, leather work, kitchen-gardening, agriculture and fishery as obviously suitable crafts.

The selected craft should be both taught and practised so that the children are able to produce articles which can be used and may be sold to meet part of the expenditure on the school.

This craft must not be taught mechanically but its social and scientific implications were to be studied side by side.

In this craft-centered education **all the subjects** to be taught were to be integrally **related to the selected craft or the child's physical and social environment.**

FATE OF BASIC EDUCATION

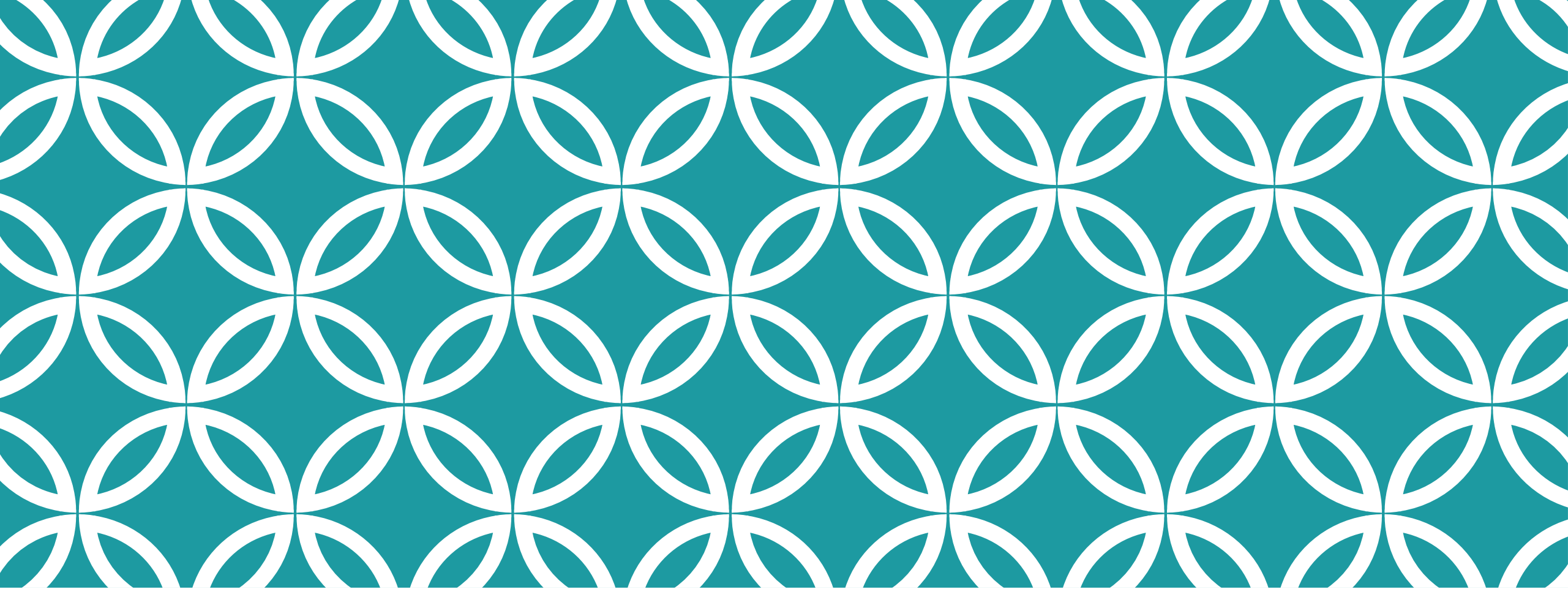
CABE appointed B G Kher (prime minister of Bombay presidency) to look into the feasibility of Zakhir Hussain plan- 1938

Recommended – **basic education to be first introduced in rural areas .. General (regular) education till class V** , after this they can choose other schools till 16 years of age.

Post Kher committee report, congress ministers faced problem of alienation by of workers and *Kisans*...

Faced severe financial problems due to low tax revenues.
Vallabhbhai Patel warned of severe consequences

Hopes of education revival lost



SARGENT PLAN- POSTWAR EDUCATION RECONSTRUCTION OF INDIA



SARGENT PLAN

Plan for post war educational developments in India- Indian Independence was almost immanent

Sir John Sargent, the Educational Adviser to the Government of India was asked to prepare a comprehensive report on education.

Also called: '**Report by the Central Advisory Board of Education**' and also as the '**Plan for post-war educational reconstruction in India**'.

CABE accepted report in 1944.

It was the first attempt to develop a **National System for Education in India**. Full fledged educational plan for the future educational reconstruction in India

first report that present a comprehensive picture of education in our country at that period of time

http://www.kkhsou.in/main/education/sargent_report.html

S C
Ghosh

PAMPHLET No. 27

Post-War Educational Development in India

REPORT BY THE CENTRAL ADVISORY
BOARD OF EDUCATION

January 1944

Fifth Edition (1947)

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MAIN PROPOSALS

The report had **maintained that in a period of not less than 40 years, the standard of Indian education will be made equivalent to that of England**. It had made certain policy decisions, the implications of which may have far reaching consequences. They may be outlined below—

- ▮ **Pre-primary education for children between 3 to 6 years of age. (First time)**
- ▮ **Universal, compulsory and free primary or basic education** for all children between the ages 6—11 (junior basic) and 11—14 (senior basic).
- ▮ **High school education for six years for selected children between the years 11—17.**
- ▮ **Degree course for three years beginning after the higher secondary examination for selected students**
- ▮ Technical, commercial, agricultural and art education for full time and part time students, girls schools are to teach domestic science.

SARGENT PLAN PROPOSALS : CONTD

The **liquidation of adult illiteracy and the development of public library system** in about 20 years.

Full provision for the proper training of teachers.

Educational provision be made for the physically and mentally handicapped children.

The organisation of **compulsory physical education**.

Provision be made for social and recreational activities.

The creation of employment bureaus.

The **creation of department of Education in the centre and in the states**.

The use of mother tongue is to be used as the medium of instruction in all high schools.

SARGENT PLAN: UNIVERSITY EDUCATION

The duration of degree course should be of 3 years.

- ▶ The standard of university education must be raised. The condition of admission must be revised so that capable students can take the advantage of the university course.

Competent teachers should be appointed in the university and steps should be taken to improve the conditions of service including remuneration.

Emphasis should be given on establishing a high standard in post-graduate studies and in pure applied research.

For coordination in the activities of the different universities an All India Organization like **University Grants Committee** of England should be set up.

EVALUATION OF SARGENT PLAN: MERITS

Comprehensive scheme embracing all aspects of education— pre-primary, primary, high school and university education. Technical, vocational and professional.

It recommended the provision of equal opportunities to all the students at various stages of education.

Thirdly, **due importance was given to the teaching profession.** Recommendations were made for the improvement of the salary scales and the service conditions of the teachers.

For the first time the **attention of the Government was drawn towards the education of the handicapped.**

The report gave importance on providing education in such a manner as to make one self depended. It foresaw the importance of the employment problem in the country and thought that education could be instrumental in solving it.

EVALUATION OF SARGENT PLAN: SHORTCOMINGS

The report **outlined an educational development in India which would require 40 years to be implemented**. This time limit did not satisfy any ardent educationist. An acceptable plan of educational development in India had been spread over a much shorter range of time, not exceeding 15 years.

It had been pointed out that it would be wrong to call it a national scheme of education because it was only a copy of the pattern practised in England. This pattern could not serve as a model to India because the social, political and economic conditions in the two countries are vastly different.

The proposal for selective admission in schools, colleges and universities was undemocratic.

IMPLEMENTATION OF SARGENT PLAN RECOMMENDATION

In 1945 **an education department was established at the centre to increase administrative efficiency.**

40 crores of rupees were given to the provincial Governments for implementing certain aspects of the scheme in their areas.

The Provincial Governments were advised to make five year plans for education.

Decided that the **scheme should be implemented within 16 years instead of 40 year.**

According to the recommendations of the committee **University Grants Committee was constituted in 1945** which later on became **University Grants Commission in 1956.**

The **aim of providing compulsory and free education to children between 6—11 years of age was accepted.**

Efforts were made for adult education and also for improving the economic condition of teachers.

The committee of polytechnic school and the **All India Technical Education**
http://www.kkhsou.in/main/education/sargent_report.html

STATE OF EDUCATION AT INDIA'S INDEPENDENCE

Population in 1947 : **around 406 million** (India + Pakistan combined)

Elementary Education:

- ▢ **Elementary schools: 1.72 lakhs** (decline from 1.89 lakhs in 1936-37)
- ▢ **Number of pupils : 1.3 crore** (increase from 1.05 crore in 1937)
- ▢ **Expenditure: 15.5 crores**

Secondary Education:

- ▢ **Number of schools: 17,250** (Increase from 13,400 in 1936-37)
- ▢ **Number of Pupils: 36.06 lakhs** (Increase from 23.93 lakhs in 1936-37)
- ▢ **Expenditure: 17.9 crores**

Higher Education:

- ▢ **15 Universities**, 16,000 students , expenditure – 2.03 crores
- ▢ **300 Arts and Science Colleges**, Pupils: 96,000 , expenditure- 3.53 crores
- ▢ **16 engineering and technical colleges**, 72,000 students; expenditure – 2.73 crores



